Kerstin Holzheu

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Macroeconomics and labor economics: wage setting, worker mobility, firm productivity, skills.

APPOINTMENTS

2019–present	Assistant Professor, Sciences Po
2023–2024	Visiting Fellow and Visiting Professor, Yale University / Cowles Foundation
March 2023	Visiting Fellow, EIEF
2018–2019	Postdoctoral Fellow, Institute for Fiscal Studies
July–September 2014	PhD Trainee, European Central Bank, Prices and Costs Division
2010–2011	Research Assistance Trainee, European Central Bank, DG Research
March–September 2009	Trainee, GTZ Good Financial Governance Program, Ghana

OTHER AFFILIATIONS

since 2018	IZA Research Fellow
since 2025	CESifo Fellow

EDUCATION

May 2018	PhD in Economics, University of Chicago Main advisor: Robert Shimer. Other advisors: Stéphane Bonhomme, Thibaut Lamadon, Harald Uhlig.
2010	MSc Macroeconomic Policy and Financial Markets, Barcelona GSE
2004-2009	MA & BA Empirical Social Sciences and MA Applied Economics French-German Double Diploma in Social Sciences University of Stuttgart, Germany & Sciences Po Bordeaux, France
2004	Abitur Mathematics & Physics, Albert-Schweitzer-Gymnasium Spezialschulteil, Erfurt, Germany

PUBLICATIONS AND FORTHCOMING ARTICLES

[1] Life-Cycle Wage Growth and Firm Productivity in Developed and Developing Economies. With Juan Muñoz-Morales. *International Economic Review*, forthcoming.

[2] The Two Faces of Worker Specialization. With Zsófia Bárány. *Labour Economics*, 98, 2026.

[3] How Much Should We Trust Estimates of Firm Effects and Worker Sorting? With Stéphane Bonhomme, Thibaut Lamadon, Elena Manresa, Magne Mogstad and Bradley Setzler. *Journal of Labor Economics*, 41(2), 2023.

WORKING PAPERS

[1] Wage Bargaining and Wage Posting Firms. With Jean-Marc Robin. *Revise and resubmit, Review of Economic Studies.*

[2] The Role of Workers in Knowledge Diffusion Across Firms. With Anders Akerman. *Revise and resubmit, Review of Economic Dynamics.*

[3] Lost Knowledge and New Products: Event-Study Evidence from Worker Deaths. With Anders Akerman. *Revise and resubmit, Labour Economics.*

[4] Separations on the Job Ladder. With Lewin Nolden. Under review.

[5] Workplace Amenities and the Gender Pay Gap. With Nabanita Datta Gupta, Yana Gallen and Kristian Stamp Hedeager. At NBER Summer Institute 2026, Gender in the Economy.

[6] Worker Wealth and the Option of Self-Employment. Sole-authored working paper; ANR FIRM-SIZE project.

[7] Preserving Jobs, Freezing Dynamics? Employment Effects of Conditional Inheritance Tax Relief. With Charlotte Bartels, Theresa Bührle, Gedeão Locks and Duncan Roth. Working paper. Under review.

WORK IN PROGRESS

[1] The Option Value of Distance: Wages and Commuting in a Spatial Labor Market. With Elena Mattana.

[2] Acqui-Hires. With Pauline Corblet.

[3] Worker Specialization and the Aggregate Economy. Sole-authored.

CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATIONS

2026	SED; Barcelona Summer Forum; FAU–IAB Macro-Labor Workshop; Sciences Po–UCL Macro Workshop; SaM Conference, Amsterdam; SaM Workshop, Paris. *Prospective:* University of Bristol; University of Warwick.
2025	CREST; SED; World Congress of the Econometric Society; Joint Columbia/Sciences Po Workshop; INSEAD/Collège de France/PSE; IAB Workshop "Identifying Worker and Firm Quality"; 3rd Oslo Public-Labor Workshop
2024	Yale University; IE University; Lisbon Macro Conference; SED; GEA Conference; ECB; Macro-Labor Workshop Konstanz; IFS
2023	SOLE; University of Mannheim; University of Bristol; EIEF; Bocconi; GEA Conference
2022	SOLE; SED; University of Edinburgh; University of Stavanger; NBER Wage Dynamics in the 21st Century; Essex SaM; Christmas Conference Berlin
2021	SOLE; Spring Meeting of Young Economists; Labor Market Workshop (University Bonn & Mannheim); EEA; IESEG; Sciences Po
2020	Banque de France; Sciences Po
2019	University of Melbourne; UNSW; Royal Holloway (University of London); E1-Macro QMQM Workshop (Queen Mary University)
2018	Aarhus University; Bonn University; CEMFI; ECB; EINAUDI; IESE; IFS; USC Marshall; University of Montreal; Penn State University; Sciences Po; UBC; UCSB
2016	Midwest Search and Matching Workshop
2015	Federal Reserve Bank of New York

RESEARCH GRANTS

- **ANR JCJC FIRMSIZE**; sole PI; EUR 52,891; October 2024–September 2027 (ANR-24-CE26-3565).
- **Sciences Po Scientific Advisory Board research grant**; sole PI; EUR 30,700; 2027–2028. Acqui-Hires project.
- **Sciences Po Scientific Advisory Board research grant**; sole PI; EUR 40,000; 2023–2025. Supported *The Role of Workers in Knowledge Diffusion Across Firms* and *Lost Knowledge and New Products: Event-Study Evidence from Worker Deaths*, both with Anders Akerman, and *The Option Value of Distance: Wages and Commuting in a Spatial Labor Market*, with Elena Mattana.
- **Banque de France / Sciences Po Partnership Research Grant**; EUR 30,000; 2020–2025.

HONORS, SCHOLARSHIPS AND FELLOWSHIPS

- Schultz Endowment Fellowship, University of Chicago, 2016–2017.
- CSWEP Summer Research Fellowship, Federal Reserve Bank of New York, 2015 (10 weeks).
- Social Sciences Full Fellowship, University of Chicago, 2011–2017.
- Tuition waiver, Barcelona Graduate School of Economics, 2010.
- Tuition refund for exceptional performance, University of Stuttgart, 2010/2012.
- Abitur prize, German Physical Society (DPG), 2004.
- Prizewinner, Jugend forscht state competition; qualified for the federal competition, 2003.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Sciences Po

The Economy / Core Economics, first-year undergraduate introductory economics, 2019–2026 (approximately 400 students).
Labor Economics and Policy, second-year course (approximately 40 students).

University of Chicago/ Booth School of Business
(Lecturer) Fiscal and Monetary Policy (Autumn 2014 & Spring 2015), (TA) Introduction to Advanced Macroeconomic Analysis (Winter 2013), Introduction to Microeconomics & Introduction to Macroeconomics (Winter 2016-Autumn 2017), Advanced Macroeconomics, Honors (Autumn 2012), (TA) Leading and Managing Teams (Spring 2017), Going To Market: Managing Channel Strategy (Spring 2016)

SUPERVISION AND MENTORING

Co-supervision of PhD students at Sciences Po: Daniel Gyetvai, Marco Palladino and Tianxiang Yuan.

Research mentoring: Lewin Nolden, formerly my research assistant and now my coauthor while completing his PhD at Oxford.

CONFERENCE AND WORKSHOP ORGANIZATION

- **June 2027:** AI and Labor Markets: Evidence, Measurement, and Policy, Paris, 10–11 June. Co-organizer with Georgetown University in Qatar and OECD. Keynote speakers: Philippe Aghion and Luis Garicano.
- **January 2027:** Search and Matching Workshop, Andorra. Sole organizer.

- **June 2026:** Search and Matching Workshop, Sciences Po. Lead organizer; co-organized with Jean-Marc Robin and Pierre Cahuc.
- **January 2026:** Search and Matching Workshop, Aussois. Lead organizer; co-organized with Jean-Marc Robin.

INSTITUTIONAL RESPONSIBILITIES

2026–2027	Co-organizer, Macro Seminar, Sciences Po.
2025–2027	Co-organizer, Departmental Seminar, Sciences Po.
2023–2026	Co-organizer, Labor Reading Group, Sciences Po.
2021–2026	Member, Selection Committee for International Master's Students, Sciences Po.
2020–2022	Co-organizer, Macro Reading Group, Sciences Po.
2020	Member, Junior Recruiting Committee, Sciences Po.

REFEREEING

American Economic Review; American Economic Review: Insights; Journal of Political Economy; Journal of Political Economy Microeconomics; Review of Economic Studies; Economic Journal; Economica; Economic Policy; Journal of Urban Economics; Journal of the Royal Statistical Society: Series A; Labour Economics.

Working-paper reviewing: Banque de France.

PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

- Invited expert interview comparing inflation in Germany and France, "Update Wirtschaft," tagesschau24 / ARD, 20 October 2022.
- Interviewed and quoted in *Die Zeit*, September 2022.